

Justification for Venue Selection: Paradise Point Resort for The Science of Consciousness Conference 2026

The selection of Paradise Point is based on **total program value, functional suitability, and risk reduction**, rather than nominal room rate.

First, Paradise Point provides a **fully integrated conference environment** where lodging, meeting space, dining, and informal interactions are co-located within a single resort setting. This minimizes transportation needs and reduces logistical complexity for a multi-day, high-density academic meeting. In contrast, the Hyatt requires greater reliance on distributed infrastructure and external movement between spaces.

Second, Paradise Point offers **substantially higher functional capacity aligned with the conference structure**, including a 700-person general session room plus multiple concurrent breakout rooms and dedicated exhibit areas already pre-configured in the contract.

This directly matches the program requirements without requiring reconfiguration or overflow solutions, thereby reducing operational risk.

Third, the Paradise Point contract includes **material cost offsets and bundled value** that are not captured in the base room rate comparison:

- Resort fee fully waived, valued at \$46 per room per night
- Complimentary meeting space contingent on F&B minimum
- 20% AV discount and 10% F&B discount
- Multiple included amenities and on-site activities that support attendee experience without additional cost
- Lower parking cost relative to standard rates

When these are accounted for, the **effective total cost differential is significantly reduced**.

Fourth, Paradise Point supports **higher attendee engagement and retention**, which is critical for scientific conferences where informal discussions and networking drive value. The contained resort layout promotes continuous interaction outside formal sessions, unlike urban or business hotel layouts.

Finally, the Paradise Point agreement includes **greater operational certainty**:

- Pre-allocated room block and meeting space matched to attendance projections
- Integrated event flow across plenary, breakout, and exhibit spaces
- Reduced dependency on external vendors or transportation logistics